The Memory Cycle Journal

LEAD STORY KEY NUMBERS FROM THE INBOX ON X CYCLE TRACKER EVENTS STUDY CORNER

SAMSUNG 2027 SUPPLY UNDER LTA
75–80% Incl. HBM · per KED (industry sources) · Nvidia, Google, Microsoft named

MICRON, OCT 9 CLOSE
$1,029.00 −0.66% · week of OpenAI scare · Range $1,017.00–$1,054.17

LEAD STORY

CONTRACTS

Samsung Signs Away Most of 2027 Before It Is Built

Long-term deals now cover an estimated 75–80% of next year's memory output, as an Apple order cut shows where the price pass-through stops

By the Memory Cycle Desk · Tel Aviv · Data as of 08:30 IDT

KEY NUMBERS · THE CYCLE IN NUMBERS

CONTRACTS

Samsung 2027 output under LTA (KED)	**~75–80%**
Samsung LTA target, Jul 30 call	**60–70% of capacity**
Conv. DRAM contract 4Q (TrendForce)	**+10–15%**
NAND contract 4Q (TrendForce)	**+15–20%**

SPOT (LAST PRINT, OCT 8 ASIA CLOSE)

DDR5 16Gb	**$58.667 · ▲0.46%**
DDR4 8Gb 3200	**$46.400 · ▲0.09%**

DEMAND SIGNALS

iPhone 18 Pro Oct component orders	**−15% to −20%**
Nvidia off-B/S obligations (10-Q)	**$530B vs $184B**
OpenAI net ARR, year-end target	**~$70B (Bloomberg)**

STOCK MOVES, OCT 9

Micron ($1,029.00)	**−0.66%**
Korea / Taiwan	**closed**

Sources: KED Global; Digital Today; TrendForce; @skylabintel / DRAMeXchange (spot); Nikkei Asia; SemiAnalysis; Bloomberg via digest; StockAnalysis (MU close).

Samsung Electronics has secured long-term supply agreements covering about 75–80% of its planned memory production for next year, the Korea Economic Daily reported Friday, as Nvidia, Google and Microsoft seek to lock in supply for five years or more. SK hynix and Micron are also signing large long-term contracts, the report said. Samsung has not disclosed contract terms; the figure comes from industry sources.

How the deals work. On its July 30 call Samsung said it aimed to put 60–70% of capacity under multi-year contracts: a rolling five-year base renewed yearly, with deposit-like prepayments, about a quarter of which it had already received (Digital Today, TrendForce). It expects the shortage to deepen in 2027 and run into 2028, citing a 3.5-year lead time from new fab to wafers.

> *"Long-term agreements could leave manufacturers exposed when the cycle turns."*
> — KED Global, deck of Oct 9 report

The tape. Micron closed Friday at $1,029.00, −0.66%, after the 4.79% drop on Thursday's OpenAI report. Korea and Taiwan were shut for holidays. Bloomberg's report that OpenAI expects ~$70 billion net annualized revenue by year-end took some of the funding scare out.

Why it matters for the cycle. Contracts with deposits turn a spot-driven business into a backlog. That lowers the odds of a 2027 price collapse. It does not fix the price: quarterly resets still reprice bits, and contract ceilings and floors decide who wears the next downturn.

Our call: late upcycle, tight through 2027. Slightly tighter than Oct 9 on volume visibility; consumer demand is the soft spot.

DEMAND

Apple Trims iPhone 18 Pro Orders as Memory Costs Bite

Apple told some suppliers to cut October component orders for the iPhone 18 Pro and Pro Max by at least 15% vs its first request; one supplier said 15–20%, Nikkei Asia reported. The phones cost $100 more than last year's, a rise tied to memory costs. Chinese media later said Pro orders fell slightly while Pro Max rose slightly UNCONFIRMED.



Image: MacRumors

NVIDIA

Nvidia's Memory Bill Shows Up Off the Balance Sheet

SemiAnalysis says Nvidia's latest 10-Q disclosed $530B of gross off-balance-sheet obligations across six line items, up from $184B a quarter earlier, mainly supply commitments, "primarily commitments to buy memory." The largest buyer is pre-committing, the same story as the LTAs. ANALYST VIEW

FROM THE INBOX

NEW **2027 is mostly contracted.** The pre-market semis digest leads with the Korean report that Samsung has locked 75–80% of next year's memory supply, including HBM. Its read: volume risk for 2027 falls, but a Jefferies Asia note says Rubin Ultra's lower memory spec pulls 2027 blended HBM pricing to $25–26/GB vs $30–32 expected. Semis pre-market digest, Oct 9, 15:08 IDT

NEW **First sign of demand destruction.** Same digest on the Nikkei iPhone 18 Pro order cut: "the first clear sign that memory inflation is destroying consumer demand." Jefferies Asia says Apple has been more conservative on shipments since early September. Semis pre-market digest · Jefferies desk notes

NEW **OpenAI scare half-reversed.** Bloomberg reports OpenAI expects ~$70B net annualized revenue by year-end vs ~$50B in September. Jefferies' Chris Wood: the cycle ends when markets stop funding debt-financed capex, so watch AI credit spreads, not ARR. Digest · Jefferies Global Semis Daily, Oct 9

Also in the inbox. Jefferies Blayne's Bytes (MRVL analyst day, OCP preview); Cantor Tech Daily on AI spec and OpenAI. No TrendForce, company IR or equipment-maker mail since the last edition. Personal inbox not scanned (connector needs re-authorization). Work inbox, Oct 9

ON X · SINCE LAST EDITION

@jukan05 UNCONFIRMED
Korean media: *"ASML has raised prices by 10% across all DUV and EUV replacement parts supplied to Samsung and SK hynix."*
x.com/jukan05/status/2108753810130903062

@jukan05 UNCONFIRMED
"I'm hearing Apple still hasn't signed any long-term memory supply agreements." Korean analysts reportedly see sharp DRAM and NAND hikes for Apple early next year.
x.com/jukan05/status/2108696044280463478

@SemiAnalysis_ ANALYST VIEW
Nvidia's 10-Q: $530B of off-balance-sheet obligations, up from $184B, driven by supply commitments, *"primarily commitments to buy memory"*.
x.com/SemiAnalysis_/status/2108724444138983719

@skylabintel
Kioxia to demo a GP-series SSD on 3rd-gen XL-FLASH at more than 20M 512-byte random-read IOPS, over 2x the GP1.
x.com/skylabintel/status/2108634551706964166

@pequityresearch UNCONFIRMED
Relays Goldman: Samsung HBM revenue $81B in 2027 (+321% y/y). Note not seen.
x.com/pequityresearch/status/2108738946993689022

@SemiconductorsX UNCONFIRMED
Relays Goldman: Samsung OP ₩373.5T next year, *"most of it is conventional DRAM, not HBM."*
x.com/SemiconductorsX/status/2108732456471781649

All posts were opened through the X API and quoted as written. Relayed bank figures and media reports are claims, not confirmed facts.

CYCLE TRACKER

Volume locked in; consumer demand cracks

GAUGE	TODAY VS OCT 9	NUDGE
Demand	Hyperscalers pre-commit (LTAs, Nvidia $530B); iPhone Pro cut; OpenAI ARR scare eases	**Mixed**
Supply	Samsung 2027 ~75–80% contracted; ASML parts +10% UNCONFIRMED	**Tighter**
Inventory	No new data (~8 wks)	**Flat**
Contract vs spot	No new spot print (Asia holidays)	**Flat**
HBM pricing	Jefferies Asia: 2027 HBM $25–26/GB vs $30–32 expected	**Looser (price)**
Valuation	MU flat-ish after Thursday's drop	**—**

VERDICT
Late upcycle; tight through 2027, unchanged. vs Oct 9: slightly tighter. Contracted 2027 volume and the OpenAI ARR rebound outweigh the iPhone order cut and softer 2027 HBM price talk. Price momentum is still slowing; 2028+ still looser as new fabs build.

EVENTS CALENDAR · OCT 10–29 · TIMES ISRAEL (IDT)

Sat 10	Taiwan September monthly-revenue deadline.	calendar
Mon 12	**Nanya 3Q call**. Korea Oct 1–10 exports. OCP Global Summit opens (to Oct 15).	calendar
Mon 12–Thu 15	SEMICON West, San Francisco.	confirmed
Wed 14 · 08:00	**ASML Q3 results**. TrendForce weekly spot. US CPI 15:30.	confirmed
Thu 15 · 09:00	**TSMC 3Q26 results**: capex, CoWoS capacity.	confirmed
Fri 16	Bank of Korea Sep export price index (DRAM).	calendar
Thu 22 · 00:00	**Lam Research Sep-qtr call**.	Lam IR
~Tue 27	SK hynix 3Q results (not yet on IR).	tentative
Wed 28 · 21:00	FOMC decision.	confirmed

Thu 29	**Samsung full 3Q results**: HBM, capex, LTA disclosure.	Korea Times
Mon Nov 2	Apple Sep-qtr results.	etf.net

Sources: prior-edition calendar (ASML, TSMC, Lam IR; Korea Times); etf.net.

STUDY CORNER · DAY 5 OF 14

Peak vs trough, part 2: the language of the turn

Day 5 finishes the 2018-vs-2023 quote set. Re-read yesterday's lines side by side: peak talk was "fundamentally solid" demand (Samsung, 2017) and a market "structurally different" (Micron, 2018); trough talk was the "worst downturn in the last 13 years" (Micron, 2023) and cuts "by a meaningful level" (Samsung, 2023). Then compare with this week's language: "sold out through 2028" and five-year LTAs.

Quick questions on Day 4:

1. Micron called the market "structurally different" in Oct 2018, near the peak. Which 2026 phrase plays that role now, and what would prove it wrong?
2. Samsung in Oct 2018 blamed a coming slowdown on "seasonal effects." What is the 2026 equivalent excuse to watch for on the Oct 29 call?
3. In 2023, production cuts marked the trough. With 75–80% of 2027 under LTA, what replaces production cuts as the adjustment tool in the next downturn: price floors, deposits, or capex?

Model prep: toy Micron Bits × ASP workbook is in study/micron_bits_asp_model.xlsx, ready for Day 8 (Oct 13).

SOURCES & FURTHER READING

- KED Global: Samsung locks in 80% of next year's memory output through long-term deals
- TrendForce: Samsung targets 60–70% capacity under LTAs (Jul 30)
- MacRumors: Apple reportedly cuts iPhone 18 Pro orders
- StockAnalysis: Micron price history
- Digital Today: Samsung memory to lock in results with contracts
- Nikkei Asia: Apple cuts iPhone 18 Pro orders due to soft demand
- etf.net: Apple cut October iPhone 18 Pro component orders by at least 15%
- SemiAnalysis on Nvidia off-balance-sheet obligations (X)

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Unconfirmed reports are labeled as such. Figures are only those cited from named sources. · Edition #4 · Oct 10, 2026